This clear seafood soup uses dashi—a Japanese tuna- and seaweed-based fish stock—as its base. For those avoiding gluten in their diet, tamari may be used.

prawn and sea bass soup

SERVES 4 **PREP** 10 MINS **COOK** 5 MINS **FREEZE** NOT SUITABLE

3½oz (100g) spinach, blanched
1 quart (1 liter) dashi
3½oz (100g) sea bass fillet, cut into 4 cubes
4 large raw prawns or jumbo shrimp, peeled and deveined
1 tsp soy sauce
½ small red chile
1 scallion, chopped
1 tbsp arrowroot
few drops lemon juice

1 Squeeze as much water as possible out of the blanched spinach, then cut into strips and set aside.

2 Bring the dashi to a boil in a saucepan and add the cubed fish and the prawns or jumbo shrimp. Cook for 2–3 minutes, then add the soy sauce, chile, and scallion.

3 Whisk the arrowroot with 1 tbsp cold water in a bowl and stir into the soup. Bring to a boil and then remove the chile. Add the lemon juice and spinach and serve.